

Unit: Family Communication: Not Now, Bernard

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Unit Purpose / 單元目的

The purpose of this unit is twofold. We want to talk about some family culture that I observed in the United Kingdom and then introduce some picture books that I as an adult also enjoy reading. As a matter of fact, this unit and the following two units will introduce different types of books which are often used in English learning, including picture books, young adult literature (unit 14) and graded readers (unit 15).

本單元的目的有兩個。我們想談談我在英國觀察到的一些家庭文化，然後介紹一些我作為成年人也喜歡閱讀的繪本。事實上，本單元和接下來的兩個單元將介紹英語學習中經常使用的不同類型的書籍，包括繪本、青少年文學（第14單元）和分級讀物（第15單元）。

English Picture Books Introduction / 英文繪本引言

First of all, I would like to start with the picture books. In my childhood, I was lucky to grow up among books, literally among books. We had three bookstores downstairs, and I was allowed to access whenever the stores were open. Therefore, I did not have to buy many books for it was an 'all-you-can-read' book buffet for free to me. I did not have any picture books that I could recall, not to mention any English picture books. I grew to love English picture books when I started my doctoral study. Even though I read English with comparative fluency than most of the people, I still prefer not to read difficult texts for entertainment, such as newspaper or classic novels. I love light readings. So, when I started to research on children's literature, which covers a wide range of stories, books, and so on, I fell in love with classic picture books (even though I do not have any child) and started collecting them. Who doesn't like books with large cute pictures with only a few lines to read? After I discovered the world of picture books at the university library, I went straight to the biggest bookstore "Waterstones" and bought my very first English picture book, There was an old lady who swallowed a fly, illustrated by Pam Adams and published by Child's Play International first published in 1973 and reprinted in 2003.

首先，我想從繪本開始。在我的童年，我很幸運能在書堆中長大，字面意義上的書堆中。我們樓下有三家書店，只要書店開門，我就可以進去。因此，我不需要買很多書，因為對我來說，這是一個免費的「全書自助餐」。在我的記憶中，我沒有任何繪本，更不用說英語繪本了。當我開始博士研究時，我開始熱愛英語繪本。儘管我讀英語比大多數人流利，但我仍然不喜歡讀困難的文本消遣，例如報紙或經典小說。我喜歡輕鬆的閱讀。所以，當我開始研究兒童文學時，它涵蓋了廣泛的故事、書籍等，我愛上了經典繪本（儘管我沒有任何孩子）並開始收集它們。誰不喜歡字少、圖大又可愛的書呢？在大學圖書館發現了繪本的世界後，我直奔最大的書店「Waterstones」，買了我生平第一本英文繪本《老婆婆吞了一隻蒼蠅》（There was an old lady who swallowed a fly），由 Pam Adams 繪製，並由 Child's Play International 於1973年首次出版，並於2003年重印。

Later, I bought my favorite, Not now, Bernard, written and illustrated by David McKee and first published in Great Britain in 1980 by Andersen Press, which means the book has been around for over 40 years, classic!!!

後來，我買了我最喜歡的書《現在不行，伯納》（[Not now, Bernard](#)），由大衛·麥基（[David McKee](#)）撰寫和繪製，並於1980年由安徒生出版社在英國首次出版，這意味著這本書已經存在了40多年，堪稱經典！！！！

Picture books and bedtime story reading are tightly connected in the western culture. Many parents take their children to libraries, and schools encourage reading too. The education system also promotes reading through class reading or sustained silent reading, which is the extensive reading approach we mentioned before.

繪本和床邊故事閱讀在西方文化中緊密相連。許多父母帶孩子去圖書館，學校也鼓勵閱讀。教育系統也通過課堂閱讀或持續默讀（SSR）來促進閱讀，這就是我們之前提到的泛讀方法。

Not Now, Bernard & Family Communication / 《現在不行，伯納》與家庭溝通

As you can see in the cover of the book, the story has two characters, a little boy named Bernard and a monster. One day, Bernard, trying to attract his parents' attention but failed, went into the garden and met a monster. The monster ate Bernard, came into the house, and lived Bernard's life. Bernard's parents did not even notice the monster replacing their son. The monster ended up getting lots of "Not now, Bernard". From the story and illustrations, we observe the life of family at the time, for example, Bernard's mother put the dinner in front of the television, showing us that family dinner was not a routine in the story as well as the milk before bed. I am particularly amused by the vivid facial expressions of the monster when the monster said "But I'm a monster" in bed with the milk in hand.

正如你在書的封面所看到的，故事有兩個角色，一個名叫伯納的小男孩和一個怪物。一天，伯納試圖吸引父母的注意但失敗了，他走到花園裡遇到了一個怪物。怪物吃掉了伯納，走進屋子，過著伯納的生活。伯納的父母甚至沒有注意到怪物取代了他們的兒子。怪物最終得到了很多「現在不行，伯納」。從故事和插圖中，我們觀察到當時家庭的生活，例如，伯納的母親把晚餐放在電視機前，向我們展示了故事中家庭晚餐不是常規，睡前的牛奶也是如此。當怪物手拿牛奶在床上說「但我是一個怪物」時，怪物生動的臉部表情特別讓我感到好笑。

The story also showed us that parents could misbehave by ignoring their children and turn them into little monsters (Ferguson, 2020). Or, as Hancock (2014) wrote, this book demonstrates that "parents can be naughty too" and that "when we don't listen to people, monsters can take over."

故事還向我們表明，父母可能會因為忽視孩子並將他們變成小怪物而表現不佳 (Ferguson, 2020)。或者，正如 Hancock (2014年) 所寫，這本書表明「父母也可以很調皮」，而且「當我們不聽人說話時，怪物就會接管。」

Bernard's Dialogue / 伯納對話錄

Child: Mum, look!! Parent: Not now, dear!

孩子：媽媽，看！！家長：現在不行，寶貝！

Child: But..... look! Parent: NOT NOW, dear!!! Child:

孩子：但是.....看！家長：現在不行，寶貝！！！孩子：.....

How often do we hear or say this in the daily life? I have a very dear friend who is probably the best parent I have ever seen in life. She never got loud or mad at her children when I met them at the age of 12 and 14. She always listened to the children, and they had dinner together most of the time. When they sat and ate, books, phones or TVs were not allowed; they focused on how their days were and on each other, even for just a half hour. I know this because I lived with them for nearly two years and watched how she and her husband took care of their children, who turn out to become excellent adults now. In situations like the conversation above, she would always answered: "Yes, dear. What is it?"

我們在日常生活中多頻繁地聽到或說這句話？我有一個非常要好的朋友，她可能是我一生中見過最好的家長。當我在孩子們12歲和14歲時遇見他們時，她從不對孩子們大聲喧嘩或生氣。她總是傾聽孩子們的聲音，他們大部分時間都在一起吃晚餐。當他們坐下來吃飯時，書本、手機或電視都是不允許的；他們專注於彼此的一天是怎麼過的，甚至只有半小時。我知道這一點，因為與他們一起生活了將近兩年，看著她和她的丈夫如何照顧他們的孩子，他們現在都成為了優秀的成年人。在像上面那樣的談話情況下，她總是會回答：「是的，寶貝。怎麼了？」

Recently, new illustrations of the book have been created to reflect the daily life of families in the age of technology. Digital devices, such as smartphones and tablets are added to the new version. The author, David McKee, aged 85, revealed to the Observer that "He thinks listening to children is one of the most important

thing a parent can do – and during the lockdown, when children are isolated from their teachers and friends, it is even more important.” He thinks good parents should make sure that they listen to their children, or at least, should take time to explain to their children why they are unavailable at that moment. McKee also thinks that one of the most important point is that neither Bernard nor the monster understand why the parents just keep on ignoring them and even the monster does not know how to ‘handle the situation’. However, parents are not the only people who get to say ‘not now’ nowadays, children say ‘not now’ to their parents, too, McKee noticed and pointed out in the interview. So, family communication is something that needs a lot of attention and deserves working on (Ferguson, 2020).

最近，這本書創作了新的插圖，以反映技術時代家庭的日常生活。智慧型手機和平板電腦等數位設備被添加到新版本中。作者大衛·麥基，85歲，向《觀察家報》透露：「他認為傾聽孩子的聲音是父母能做的最重要的事情之一——在封鎖期間，當孩子們與老師和朋友隔離時，這甚至更為重要。」他認為好父母應該確保他們傾聽孩子的聲音，或者至少應該花時間向他們的孩子解釋為什麼他們此時沒有空。麥基還認為最重要的一點是，伯納和怪物都不明白為什麼父母只是不斷忽視他們，甚至怪物也不知道如何『處理這種情況』。然而，如今父母並不是唯一會說『現在不行』的人，孩子也會對他們的父母說『現在不行』，麥基在採訪中注意到並指出了這一點。因此，家庭溝通是需要給予大量關注並值得努力改進的事情。

Other Classic Picture Books / 其他經典繪本推薦

1. I will not ever NEVER eat a tomato by Lauren Child
1. 《我絕對絕對不吃番茄》(蘿倫·柴爾德 著)
2. The Gruffalo by Julia Donaldson and Axel Scheffler
2. 《怪獸古飛樂》(茱莉亞·唐納森 著，艾賽爾·薛弗勒 繪)
3. Where the Wild Things Are by Maurice Sendak
3. 《野獸國》(莫里斯·桑達克 著)
4. Mr. Men and Little Miss book, e.g. Little Miss Wise by Roger Hargreaves
4. 《奇先生妙小姐》系列，例如《聰明小姐》(羅傑·哈格里夫斯 著)
5. Two Monsters by David McKee
5. 《兩隻怪獸》(大衛·麥基 著)
6. Under the Bed by Paul Bright and Ben Cort
6. 《床底下》(保羅·布萊特 著，班·柯特 繪)
7. The Doorbell Rang by Pat Hutchins
7. 《門鈴響了》(帕特·哈金斯 著)

Please do not automatically assume that picture books are easy readings. They generally are, but not necessarily are. I have a pop-up book called Fungus the Bogeyman by Raymond Briggs, which I think is fun and funny but difficult to read.

請不要自動認為繪本是簡單的讀物。它們通常是，但並不一定是。我有一本立體書叫《黴菌人》(Fungus the Bogeyman，雷蒙·布力格 著)，我認為它很有趣且滑稽，但很難讀。

Off the topic for a little bit.....There is another kind of book that I enjoy reading. It is traditionally not considered as children's literature, but many children love them, sort of like comic books. The one that I am introducing is a book called The Adventures of Super Diaper Baby by Pilkey in 2002. The book is full of pictures but with more texts. What I like the most is its little design of pages that you can flip while reading to create a moving effect

on some pages.

稍微偏離一下主題.....還有另一種我喜歡閱讀的書。傳統上它不被視為兒童文學，但許多孩子喜歡它們，有點像漫畫書。我正在介紹的是一本名叫《超級尿布寶貝歷險記》([The Adventures of Super Diaper Baby](#) · 皮爾奇 著於2002年) 的書。這本書充滿了圖片，但文字較多。我最喜歡的是它的翻頁小設計，您可以在閱讀時快速翻動以在某些頁面上創建移動效果 ([Flip-o-rama](#)) 。